

Rules Checklist

Where Can I Vend? (Prototype) - what the rule engine incorporates. Last updated 2026-06-04.

Status key

Status	Meaning
Live	Real City data wired in; affects verdicts and shows on the map.
Statutory	Geometry encoded from the Admin Code boundary text (approximate; no file needed).
Illustrative	Sample geometry standing in until the gated dataset arrives.
Pending	Rule is built; dormant until the City data layer is supplied.
Blocked	Needs a legal or policy decision, not just data. (Reminder = on-site only, cannot be mapped.)

A. Stay-away distances (buffers)

Rule	Distance	Applies	Status
Subway entrance / exit	10 ft	Both	Live (MTA, citywide)
Fire hydrant	10 ft (distance unverified)	Both	Live (NYCDEP; distance pending legal confirm)
Crosswalk	10 ft	Food	Pending
Street corner / intersection	10 ft	General	Pending
Driveway / curb cut	10 ft	Both	Pending (no clean City layer)
Building / store entrance (incl. grocery)	20 ft	Both	Pending
Sidewalk cafe / stoop-line stand	20 ft	Both	Pending
Bus shelter	5 ft	General	Pending
Newsstand	5 ft	General	Pending
Disabled-access (ADA) ramp	5 ft	General	Pending
Bus stop / taxi stand	Whole stop	Both	Pending
Hospital no-standing zone	Abutting sidewalk	Both	Pending
Metered parking (vending from roadway)	Not permitted	Food	Reminder

B. Where vending is allowed, placement & footprint

Rule	Condition	Status
On a public sidewalk (allowed surface)	Sidewalk only	Live (real DCP sidewalks, citywide - the green areas)
Clear sidewalk path	>= 12 ft clear	Pending (sidewalk widths)
Curb placement	Curb side only	Reminder
No touching street furniture	No contact	Reminder
No vending over grates / manholes	-	Reminder (no citywide layer)
No bike lanes	Not in a bike lane	Pending

Rule	Condition	Status
No medians (unless plaza)	-	Live (when flagged)
Scaffolding / sidewalk shed	May obstruct	Illustrative (advisory; DOB pending)
General Vendor footprint	8x3 ft, 5 ft tall; no electricity	Reminder
Mobile Food Vendor footprint	Parallel to curb; covered	Reminder

C. Zone-based prohibitions and veteran exemptions

Zone	Base rule	Veteran exemption	Status
C4 / C5 / C6 commercial zoning	Prohibited for Standard GV	Yellow & Blue exempt	Live (real DCP zoning)
Midtown Core (30-65 St, 2nd-9th/Columbus)	Prohibited for Standard & Yellow	Blue only	Statutory
Downtown Flushing	Prohibited for Standard	Yellow & Blue exempt	Statutory
Dyker Heights (holiday hours)	Restricted for Standard, Thanksgiving-New Year	Yellow & Blue exempt	Statutory
World Trade Center zone	Prohibited (limited food-street exceptions)	-	Blocked (C-1 border)

Veteran summary: Yellow = Citywide Specialized (disabled vets) -> exempt from C4/C5/C6, Flushing, Dyker Heights. Blue = Midtown Core Specialized -> all of the above plus the only license allowed in the Midtown Core. The map recolors these zones green for Yellow/Blue.

D. Time & seasonal

Rule	Condition	Applies	Status
DOHMH restricted streets	Per-street hours/days	Food	Illustrative (logic live; DS-001 pending)
Dyker Heights holiday hours	See zone table	General	Statutory
Seasonal permit validity	April 1 - October 31 only	Food	Live

E. License geography & F. Out of scope

Rule	Condition	Status
Borough-specific food permit	One borough; never Manhattan	Live
Green Cart permit	Assigned precinct; produce only	Illustrative (logic live; DS-005 pending)
Citywide food permit	All five boroughs	Live
Parks	Out of scope (DPR concessions)	Live (real Parks Properties)
Pedestrian plazas	Out of scope (DOT concessions)	Pending
Outside the five boroughs / water	Not a vending location	Live

G. Blocked / not encoded (decisions, not data)

- C-1** WTC zone boundary (Barclay vs. Vesey St) - needs SBS Legal.
- C-2** First Amendment vendor treatment (Blue-equivalent vs. general vendor) - app returns "undetermined."
- C-3** 853 license cap - intentionally not encoded (engine is cap-agnostic).
- C-6** Replace / federate / link the existing agency maps - gates the data architecture.

Precedence: rules evaluate top-to-bottom, stopping at the first match - out of scope -> hard prohibition -> zone-by-license -> time/seasonal -> distance buffers -> scaffolding -> sidewalk width -> otherwise permitted. Citations in src/engine/citations.ts; data status in docs/Data_Sources_and_Gaps.xlsx.